

THE SILENT WEIGHT OF STIGMA IN BLACK MENTAL HEALTH

Source: Journal of Health Care for the Poor and Underserved

Even with more people talking about mental health, many Black folks still feel scared to reach out. Especially when you've been taught to keep it together—no cracks, no breaks. There's fear of being judged. Fear of being misunderstood. And after too many bad experiences with the system, trust doesn't come easy.

Takeaway

Access isn't the finish line. Real change means breaking stigma, rebuilding trust, and honoring lived experience. That means providers who look like us. Language that sounds like us. Care that feels safe.

FOOD FOR THOUGHT

WHAT MESSAGES DID YOU GET—OR NEVER GET—ABOUT MENTAL HEALTH DURING A BIG CHANGE IN YOUR LIFE?

Act On It

Ready to break the silence? Tap into our wellness [events](#) and [Unboxed podcast](#)—where stigma ends and real stories begin.

